

Q1



Directions for question 1: The following question has a sentence with two blanks followed by four pairs of words as choices. From the choices, select the pair of words that can best complete the given sentence.

Clearly a/an _____ of mass production techniques, the _____ of certain aspects of our physical environment has long irked intellectuals.

☐ a) outcome . . . diversity

☐ b) result . . . invariability

☒ c) consequence . . . uniformity (Correct Answer - ✓)

☐ d) ramification . . . changeableness

Q2



Directions for questions 2 and 3: In each of the following questions, a part of the sentence is underlined and is followed by four different ways of phrasing the underlined part. Choose the correct part.

The son, who is his chief pride in his old age, is dead.

☒ a) who is his chief pride in his old age (Your answer - ✗)

☐ b) whom he dotes on in his old age

☐ c) who has left for the states in search of greener pastures

☐ d) who was the chief pride in his old age (Correct Answer - ✓)

Solution:

'Pride in' means be proud of. The son is dead now, so 'he was the chief pride' is correct. This was a feeling he had when his son was alive.

Choice (D)

Q3



Directions for questions 2 and 3: In each of the following questions, a part of the sentence is underlined and is followed by four different ways of phrasing the underlined part. Choose the correct part.

Does he thought about the consequences if he refuses the offer of someone so powerful?

☐ a) Does he thought about

☒ b) Does he know (Your answer - ✓)

☐ c) He will have to face

☐ d) Had he thought about

Q4



Directions for questions 4 and 5: A number of sentences are given below, which, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences to construct a coherent paragraph and indicate the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

1. Out of this rather mundane arrangement was born the sandwich.
2. John Montagu, the Fourth Earl of Sandwich was a man who was addicted to the gambling table and certainly did not like to be disturbed while he was at his favourite pastime.
3. He would simply carry a couple of slices of bread with a slab of meat and a dash of vegetable placed between them to the gambling table.
4. The snack, which takes its name from the Earl who lived in the 18th Century has now become an eatable popular across all frontiers.
5. Realising that he had to solve the problem of hunger in the midst of furious, unchecked gambling, Montagu hit upon what was then a novel idea.

Q5



Directions for questions 4 and 5: A number of sentences are given below, which, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences to construct a coherent paragraph and indicate the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

1. Their sentiments prompted the ceremonial welcome extended to Lord Rama many aeons ago when he returned from his 14-year exile to Ayodhya after defeating the demon King Ravana.
2. Coinciding with the 13th day of the dark fortnight of Ashwin, the festival draws its significance from the word Deepavali – literally, a string of lighted lamps.
3. The celebrations have continued to this time and age with Diwali.
4. The classic power play of good and evil reaches a telling climax with light prevailing over darkness on Diwali night.
5. The lamps accompanied by the lighting of fire crackers, symbolise mankind's quest for enlightenment by conquering all evil, vice, temptation and ignorance.

Q6



Directions for question 6: The sentences given in the following question, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is labelled with a letter. From among the choices given below the question, choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph.

- a. If it is done under compulsion, it is sure to injure the brain by subjecting it to an abnormal strain.
- b. The very function of education has been discovered to be mainly psychological in so far as it has been found to be simply useful in helping the development of the inborn faculties and not in stuffing the brain with information.
- c. Repeated voluntary exercise of the faculty is all that is suggested by them for its healthy development.
- d. For such development, repeated exercise of the faculties is recommended by psychologists.
- e. But it is essential that the impulse for the exercise comes from within.
- f. And such exercise of the faculties, according to them becomes effective only when it proceeds from voluntary efforts.

☐ a) cfdeba

☐ b) cadbef

☒ c) bdfcea (Your answer - ✓)

☐ d) bdceaf

Q7



Directions for questions 7 and 8: Each of the following sentences has a blank. From the given choices, pick the idiomatic expression that fits the blank appropriately.

Though she tried hard to please the child, the governess ____ the mother's expectations.

- ☐ a) fell through
- ☐ b) fell short of
- ☐ c) fell out of

☒ d) fell off (Your answer - ✖)

Solution:

The phrase 'fall short of' means to be deficient and is apt in the sentence. 'To fall through' means 'to be abandoned', 'to fall out' means to quarrel and 'to fall off' means to diminish or deteriorate. You 'fall back' or depend on a second alternative.

Choice (B)

Q8



Directions for questions 7 and 8: Each of the following sentences has a blank. From the given choices, pick the idiomatic expression that fits the blank appropriately.

The judge showed leniency towards the accused ____ that had led to the crime.

☒ a) from all accounts of the circumstances (Your answer - ✖)

☐ b) making agreeable the circumstances

☐ c) taking into account the circumstances (Correct Answer - ✔)

☐ d) turning to account the circumstances

Solution:

'To take into account' means to make allowance for and is the intended idiom here. 'From all accounts' means according to what other people say. 'To make agreeable' means to strive to entertain and 'turning to account' means to turn to one's advantage. To 'give a good account' is to narrate well.
Choice (C)

Q9



Directions for question 9: In the following question, the word at the top is used in four different ways, A to D. Choose the option in which the usage of the word is INCORRECT or INAPPROPRIATE.

QUARTER

- ☒ a) When she had given up all hopes, help came from an unexpected quarter. (Your answer - ✖)
- ☐ b) The soldiers waited eagerly for the quarters to be allotted so that they could bring their families.
- ☐ c) The interrogation went on for a full hour and quarter. (Correct Answer - ✔)
- ☐ d) The guide announced that we had reached the historic quarter of the city.

Q10



Directions for questions 10 to 12: In the following passage there are blanks, each of which has been numbered. These numbers are printed below the passage and against each, four words are suggested, one of which fits the blank appropriately. Find out the appropriate word in each case and mark the letter corresponding with it as your answer.

Alarmed by the continued (10) of rhinoceroses, whose horns are valued in the Far East for their (11) medicinal qualities and in the Middle East for dagger handles, wildlife officials in Namibia and Zimbabwe are sawing off and storing the horns of (12) live rhinos. Some 500 have lost their horns, which grow back at the rate of several inches a year.

- ☐ a) purloining
- ☒ b) poaching (Your answer - ✔)
- ☐ c) plundering
- ☐ d) marauding

Q11

Directions for questions 10 to 12: In the following passage there are blanks, each of which has been numbered. These numbers are printed below the passage and against each, four words are suggested, one of which fits the blank appropriately. Find out the appropriate word in each case and mark the letter corresponding with it as your answer.

Alarmed by the continued **(10)** of rhinoceroses, whose horns are valued in the Far East for their **(11)** medicinal qualities and in the Middle East for dagger handles, wildlife officials in Namibia and Zimbabwe are sawing off and storing the horns of **(12)** live rhinos. Some 500 have lost their horns, which grow back at the rate of several inches a year.

☐ a) obvious

☒ b) extensive (Your answer - ✖)

☐ c) purported

☐ d) unique (Correct Answer - ✔)

Solution:

..... whose horns are valued in Far East for their unique (unusual or special in some way) medicinal qualities. The remaining choices obvious : clear, easy to see or understand. extensive : having a great range, purported : (not necessarily in a way that is believable) are not suitable. Hence, choice (D) is the most appropriate answer.

Choice (D)

Q12

Directions for questions 10 to 12: In the following passage there are blanks, each of which has been numbered. These numbers are printed below the passage and against each, four words are suggested, one of which fits the blank appropriately. Find out the appropriate word in each case and mark the letter corresponding with it as your answer.

Alarmed by the continued (10) of rhinoceroses, whose horns are valued in the Far East for their (11) medicinal qualities and in the Middle East for dagger handles, wildlife officials in Namibia and Zimbabwe are sawing off and storing the horns of (12) live rhinos. Some 500 have lost their horns, which grow back at the rate of several inches a year.

- ☐ a) placid
- ☐ b) debilitated
- ☐ c) excited

☒ d) tranquilized (Your answer - ✓)

Solution:

..... storing the horns of tranquilized (to make unconscious by giving a drug) live rhinos.
Only the horns of a tranquilized live rhinoceros can be removed. The remaining options, placid : inactive, debilitated : weak and excited : highly enthusiastic can be eliminated.
Choice (D)

Directions for question 13: Four alternative summaries are given below the following text. Choose the option that best captures the essence of the text and mark the letter corresponding with it in the box provided below the question.

The definition of democracy as government of the people, by the people and for the people is a hackneyed phrase. It is partially true in the sense that in a democracy there is a government of the people and by the people. But is it really for the people? It cannot be asserted without fear of contradiction. Though it is difficult for any government to act totally 'for the people' it can function to meet the aspirations of the majority of people at least. But more often than not what happens in a democracy like India is that the majority opinion does not go hand in hand with what is really good for them. This is the real dilemma for the rulers in a democracy.

1. The definition of democracy, except that it is for the people, is true. Government can meet the aspirations of a majority of people if not all but the real problem is these will not result in any good for them.
2. Democracy is of and by the people. But whether it is for the people is questionable. A democratic government can fulfil the desires of a majority of people but the problem is that they are bad.
3. A democratic government is of and by the people. But whether it is for the people is debatable. It can fulfil the aspirations of at least a majority, if not all, but the difficulty is that their aspirations are not in their real interest.
4. The definition of democracy as a 'government of and by the people' is correct but as for 'for the people' it is difficult to aver. Government can satisfy the aspirations of a majority of people but doing real good for them is difficult.

Solution:

In choice (1) the last line is wrong. In (2) 'questionable' is not a correct usage. The last line is also incorrect. In Choice (4) the last sentence is inconsistent with the text. Choice (3) is pithy and hence the required answer.

Ans : (3)

Q14



Directions for question 14: In the following question, a word with its contextual usage is provided. Pick the word from among the alternatives that is the most appropriate substitute for the question word in the given context and mark the letter corresponding with it as your answer.

ACERBIC : With acerbic epigram, Peter attempted to write epitaphs on a number of reputations pointing out that many literary emperors were not wearing any clothes.

☐ a) equivocal

☒ b) caustic (Your answer - ✓)

☐ c) pallid

☐ d) ardent

Q15



Directions for question 15: The pair of CAPITALIZED words given below is followed by four pairs of words. Choose the pair which exhibits a relationship similar to that expressed in the capitalized pair.

WOOL : ACRYLIC

- ☐ a) Minutes : Day
- ☐ b) Cotton : Polyester
- ☐ c) India : Assam
- ☐ d) Nylon : Rayon

Solution:

Acrylic is a type of wool.
Similarly, Rayon is a type of Nylon.

Choice (D)